he give the notice of motion he had once proposed to give asking for an investigation into the affairs of the bank for the past five years. Before this could be placed before the Board, the Chairman arranged for a meeting between Sorabji and Masani on December 28, 1928, in F.E. Dinshaw's chambers with a view to arriving at an amicable settlement.

But Masani was in no mood to relent and handed in his resignation. It was accepted after initial hesitation and Sorabji's resignation was ignored. Sir Dinshaw unhappy with the way things had turned out also handed in his resignation. But Masani, now Sorabji's sworn enemy, had resolved that he would impeach the Managing Director later. This resolve, however, he kept to himself while resigning. He also made the extreme demand that Sorabji pay from his own pocket, the compensation for the early termination of his agreement. At a meeting in F.E. Dinshaw's office he was persuaded with difficulty to let the Board pay. He agreed to twelve months' salary even though thirty-two months was due to him because 'if the Bank is to be penalized, I would not ask for a penny more.'[18]

The highly supercharged atmosphere of the time was further complicated by a criminal suit filed by the troublesome P.D. Shamdasani against four Directors of the bank for breach of trust, stressing that the Directors were hazarding the shareholders' capital. F.E. Dinshaw feared that with such suits pending against the bank in law courts, such an impeachment would prejudice the bank's case. Moreover, there was no one who could take Sorabji's place. Masani prevailed upon the shareholders to ask the Board to take an expert opinion on 'whether the Managing Director had run the bank as a banker would run it or as no banker would run it.' It was proposed to entrust this enquiry to Mr Buckley, a former manager of the TIB, but nothing came of it.

In 1932, Masani pleaded on behalf of the shareholders that a committee of inspection be appointed to place the facts before the public. According to Karanjia, the Board found itself in a difficult position since they could not take the position that no enquiry was called for since the investigation demanded on Sir Dinshaw's notice of motion was into serious matters. On the other hand such an enquiry would endanger the credit and stability of the bank and so 'they postponed and prevaricated and the end seemed to justify their action, or lack of it, for in 1931 when the uncalled liability of ₹25 per share was converted into a Reserve liability, public faith in the